

Gabriella Aboulafia

PhD Candidate in Health Policy, Harvard University
gaboulafia@g.harvard.edu | gaboulafia.com

EDUCATION

Harvard University <i>PhD in Health Policy (Political Analysis track)</i>	2027 (expected)
Committee: Benjamin Sommers (chair), Andrea Campbell, Adrianna McIntyre, Daniel Schneider	
Harvard Kennedy School of Government <i>Master in Public Policy</i>	2023
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill <i>BS in Public Health, Department of Health Policy and Management</i>	2019

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Published:

Aboulafia, Gabriella, Amanda Chen, and David Grabowski. "Asset Spend-Down and Medicaid Enrollment in Nursing Homes," *JAMA Netw Open* 2025;8(12):e2546876. DOI: 10.1001/jamanetworkopen.2025.46876

Aboulafia, Gabriella and Daniel Schneider. "Employer-Sponsored Health Insurance for Workers in the Hourly Service Sector," *JAMA Health Forum* 2025;6(11):e254747. DOI: 10.1001/jamahealthforum.2025.4747

Aboulafia, Gabriella and Adrianna McIntyre. "How Should Children's Medicaid Eligibility Be Monitored?," *AMA J Ethics* 2025;27(9):E686-694. DOI: 10.1001/amajethics.2025.686

Aboulafia, Gabriella, Jonathan Gruber, and Benjamin D. Sommers. "The Past and Future of Medicaid and the Affordable Care Act—Support or Sabotage?," *JAMA* 2025;334(2):115-118. DOI: 10.1001/jama.2025.7109

Smith, Rebecca B., Gabriella Aboulafia, and Benjamin D. Sommers. "Who Enrolls in Coverage and Who Remains Uninsured? Medicaid Take-Up Before and After the Affordable Care Act and During Unwinding," *The Milbank Quarterly* 2025;103(2):349-389. DOI: 10.1111/1468-0009.70020

McIntyre, Adrianna, Benjamin D. Sommers, Gabriella Aboulafia, E. John Orav, Arnold M. Epstein, and Jose F. Figueroa. "Experiences with Medicaid Unwinding Among Low-Income Adults in 4 Southern States," *Health Affairs Scholar* 2025;3(5):qxaf083. DOI: 10.1093/haschl/qxaf083

McIntyre, Adrianna, Benjamin D. Sommers, Gabriella Aboulafia, Jessica Phelan, E. John Orav, Arnold M. Epstein, and Jose F. Figueroa. "Coverage and Access Changes During Medicaid Unwinding: A Survey of Low-Income Households in Four Southern States," *JAMA Health Forum* 2024;5(6):e242193. DOI: 10.1001/jamahealthforum.2024.2193

McIntyre, Adrianna, Gabriella Aboulafia, and Benjamin D. Sommers. "Preliminary Data on Unwinding Continuous Medicaid Coverage," *N Engl J Med* 2023;389:2215-2217. DOI: 10.1056/NEJMp2311336

Under Review or In Revision:

Aboulafia, Gabriella, Jonathan Gruber, and Benjamin D. Sommers. "The Rise and Fall (and Rise) of the Affordable Care Act: Varying Impacts on Coverage Over Time and Place," Accepted at *Journal of Health Economics*.

Aboulafia, Gabriella, Benjamin D. Sommers, Daniel Schneider, and Adrianna McIntyre. "Scheduling Volatility as a Barrier to Medicaid Work Requirement Compliance Among Hourly Service-Sector Workers," *Revise and Resubmit at Health Affairs*.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

The Policy Feedback Effects of Medicare Advantage (with Adrianna McIntyre)

The Political Consequences of the Expiration of the Enhanced Marketplace Subsidies (with Adrianna McIntyre)

Tort Immunity and Nursing Home Outcomes (with Deepon Bhaumik, David Grabowski, and Jill Horwitz)

SELECTED OTHER WRITING

Hacker, Jacob and Gabriella Aboulafia. “The Public Option Revisited: A Design Guide for Policymakers,” *Economic Security Project*. In press.

Aboulafia, Gabriella. “Could Medicaid Losses Dampen Voter Turnout?,” *Tradeoffs Research Corner*. November 6, 2023.

Aboulafia, Gabriella. “Opinion: Texas children at risk as pandemic-era Medicaid coverage ends,” *Austin American-Statesman*. July 23, 2023.

Collins, Sara R., Munira Z. Gunja, and Gabriella N. Aboulafia. “U.S. Health Insurance Coverage in 2020: A Looming Crisis in Affordability—Findings from the Biennial Health Insurance Survey, 2020,” Survey brief, *Commonwealth Fund*. August 2020.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Fellow for GHHP 99: Global Health and Health Policy Capstone with Prof. David Cutler (Harvard College). <i>12 undergraduate students, required weekly seminar.</i>	Spring 2026
---	-------------

Primary Instructor for HLTHPOL 3020: Graduate Reading Course for Political Analysis (Harvard GSAS). <i>Four doctoral students, required weekly seminar.</i>	Spring 2026
---	-------------

Teaching Fellow for 17.30: Making Public Policy with Prof. Andrea Campbell (MIT). <i>18 undergraduate students, required weekly seminar.</i>	Fall 2025
--	-----------

Teaching Fellow for API 201: Quantitative Analysis and Empirical Methods I with Profs. Jonathan Borck and Teddy Svoronos (Harvard Kennedy School). <i>30-50 Master’s students, optional weekly review session.</i>	Fall 2024, Fall 2025
--	-------------------------

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Fellow, Economic Security Project	2026-
-----------------------------------	-------

Distinction in Student Teaching Award (Harvard Kennedy School)	2025, 2026
--	------------

James M. and Cathleen D. Stone PhD Scholar in Inequality and Wealth Concentration, Stone Program in Wealth Distribution, Inequality, and Social Policy (Harvard University)	2024-2025
---	-----------

AHRQ T32 Kirschstein National Research Service Award Trainee	2023-2025
--	-----------

Dean’s Award for Excellence in Student Teaching (Harvard Kennedy School)	2023
--	------

Graduate Prize Fellowship (Harvard University). <i>Recognizes a select group of prospective PhD students who show exceptional promise to expand the diversity of experience and thought on Harvard’s campus.</i>	2023
--	------

Winston Health Policy Scholar. <i>Scholarship award that recognizes excellence and achievement for students in master’s degree programs in health administration, health policy, and public health.</i>	2022
---	------

Harvard Kennedy School Malcolm Wiener Center for Social Policy’s Policy Analysis Grant Award. <i>To conduct research for Policy Analysis Exercise (MPP capstone).</i>	2022
---	------

REFeree SERVICE

Health Affairs, Health Affairs Scholar, Health Services Research, JAMA Health Forum, Journal of Health Economics, Journal of Health Politics, Policy, and Law

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

Graduate Student Representative, Health Politics and Policy Section of the American Political Science Association	2026-
Methods and Data Council, AcademyHealth	2023-2025
Annual Research Meeting Abstract Reviewer, AcademyHealth	2024
Harvard Undergraduate Public Policy Leadership Conference Application Review Team	2022

PROFESSIONAL RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, David Grabowski (Harvard Medical School)	2024-
Research Assistant, Adrianna McIntyre (Harvard Chan School of Public Health)	2022-
Research Assistant, Austin Frakt (Harvard Chan School of Public Health)	2022-2024
Research Assistant, Jose Figueroa (Harvard Chan School of Public Health)	2022-2024
Special Assistant to the Assistant Secretary for Legislation (Office of the Assistant Secretary for Legislation, US Department of Health and Human Services)	Summer 2022
Program Assistant, Health Care Coverage and Access (The Commonwealth Fund)	2019-2021

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

“Federalism in Practice: State Policy Discretion and Coverage and Market Outcomes in the ACA,” APPAM (<i>panel</i>)	2026 (<i>upcoming</i>)
“The Rise and Fall (and Rise) of the Affordable Care Act,” APSA Health Policy and Politics Section Conference (<i>poster</i>)	2025
“Health, Health Care Costs, and Attitudes Towards Government,” APSA Annual Meeting (<i>panel</i>)	2024
“Pandemic-Era Coverage Changes and Health Insurance Inequality Among Hourly Service-Sector Workers,” (with Daniel Schneider) AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting <i>Selected as one of two student papers to be presented on a panel at the State Health Policy Research Interest Group discussion.</i>	2024
“Disruptions in Coverage and Economic Adversity: Findings from a Survey of Adults with Low Incomes,” (with Adrianna McIntyre and Benjamin Sommers) AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting (<i>poster</i>)	2024
“The Effects of the Affordable Care Act on Women’s Health and Remaining Challenges,” (with Munira Z. Gunja and Sara R. Collins) AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting (<i>virtual poster</i>)	2020

MEDIA MENTIONS

Denean, A, “Millions losing Medicaid coverage over missed calls, paperwork and confusion about rules.” <i>The National Desk</i> . August 9, 2023.
Klibanoff, E, “500,000 Texans have been dropped from the Medicaid rolls since April.” <i>Texas Tribune</i> . July 17, 2023.
Mastroianni, B, “Millions May Lose Medicaid Coverage, Here’s How to Check Your Status.” <i>Health</i> . March 15, 2023.